Administrative Procedures for Judge William S. Henry

Index

I. **Civil Cases**

a. Hearing Time
   i. General Procedures Pg. 2
   ii. Motion Calendar Docket Pg. 5
b. Good Faith Certification for Motions Pg. 6
c. Setting Trials Pg. 7
d. Jury Trial Dockets Pg. 8
e. Zoom Instructions Pg. 9
f. Submission of Proposed Orders Pg. 10
g. Submission of Hearing Materials Pg. 12
h. Cancellations Pg. 14
i. Certification Regarding Standing Order And Administrative Procedures Pg. 15

II. Family Law Cases

a. Hearing Time General Procedures Pg. 16
b. Motion Calendar Docket Pg. 18
c. Good Faith Certification for Motions Pg. 19
d. Final Hearing Dates Pg. 20
e. Zoom Appearances Pg. 21
f. Submission of Proposed Orders Pg. 22
g. Submission of Hearing Materials Pg. 24
h. Cancellations Pg. 25

Civil – Hearing Time
General Procedures

1. Verify Judge Henry is the judge assigned to the case.

2. **PLEASE NOTE, for any matter that has not been set for hearing as of the effective date of this update, all specially set hearings (not including the Court's Motion Calendar Docket) will be held IN PERSON (not via Zoom) at the Bay County Courthouse, unless the Court specifically grants a request to appear via Zoom. Just because an attorney's office may be located outside of Bay County is not grounds to request to appear via Zoom. Frivolously requesting to appear via Zoom without demonstrating good cause or need may result in the imposition of sanctions.**

   Other than matters set on the Court's Motion Calendar Docket (see pg. 5), all specially set hearings will be for at least a thirty-five (35) minute hearing time.

3. DO NOT call the judge's office to request hearing time.

4. Email any request for hearing time to Judge Henry's assistant, Brittany Smith, and CC opposing counsel. These requests can be sent to smithb@jud14.flcourts.org. Use Bay County case number and style of case as your subject line

5. Provide the following information in the hearing time request email:
   a. Type of motion(s) to be heard
   b. Actual amount of time needed for counsel to argue motion(s)
   c. First date movant is available for hearing (see #7 below)
   d. Names of attorneys that will attend hearing
   e. Attach a copy of the motion(s) to the email

6. Please be accurate in the amount of time needed for the hearing. Failure to have sufficient time for the hearing may result in the motion or request being denied or the hearing continued.

7. Most motions, except dispositive motions, should be set for hearing within sixty (60) days of being filed, with simpler motions (such as motions to compel) being set for hearing within thirty (30) days of filing. Failure to timely set a hearing on a motion may result in the motion being summarily denied without hearing.

8. The judicial assistant will "reply all" to the email with available dates, times and instructions. READ ENTIRE EMAIL. **Be aware that Bay County is in the central time zone**. Outside of the Motion Calendar Docket (see pg. 5), all hearing times are in fifteen (15) minute increments.

9. The judicial assistant will provide up to five (5) dates and times for a hearing. **IN THE EVENT COUNSEL CANNOT AGREE** on a mutually convenient date and time for the hearing from the dates and times provided, **the Court may unilaterally set the matter for hearing or alternatively enter an order on the matter without hearing**. If the Court unilaterally sets the matter for hearing, the hearing cannot be canceled without a Court order. If the parties resolve the issue prior to the Court-scheduled hearing, they shall submit an agreed upon proposed order more than one (1) business day prior to hearing date to avoid the requirement for appearance at the Court-scheduled hearing. Accordingly, to the extent possible, counsel should seek another attorney from their office to cover a hearing to avoid either having no choice in the date and time of a hearing or waiving a hearing on the matter.

10. Only email the judicial assistant to request dates and confirm the hearing date. DO NOT include the judicial assistant in email chains between counsel and/or staff to clear dates (or anything else).

11. If a *pro se* party is involved in the case, an attempt should be made to coordinate the hearing date and time with the *pro se* party. If counsel receives no response to an initial attempt to coordinate with the *pro se* party after two (2) business days, counsel may unilaterally set the hearing.

12. DO NOT file a notice of hearing before receiving a confirmation email from the judicial assistant confirming that the hearing has been set.

13. Email the judicial assistant a copy of all notices for hearing once filed.

14. Any motions noticed, but not specifically scheduled with the judicial assistant, will not be heard.

15. Additional motions cannot be piggybacked on a previously scheduled hearing time without being cleared with the judicial assistant and opposing counsel, and such motions may only potentially be added if sufficient time has been reserved. To add a motion to a previously scheduled hearing, obtain opposing counsel's consent to the addition, then email the judicial assistant about adding the motion to the hearing **and advise if additional time is required**. The judicial assistant will confirm the addition of the motion to the hearing time. If additional time is required but not available, the request to piggyback a motion will be denied and the motion will need to be reset at a different date and time. Do not prepare and file a notice of the added motion until receipt of the judicial assistant's confirmation.

16. Address: 300 E. 4th Street, Panama City, FL 32401. There is no room number – just list as Judge Henry's Chambers.

17. The parties may stipulate to having a motion decided without the necessity of a hearing. If such is the case, the movant shall include at least a brief memorandum of law as part of the

motion being filed or as a supplemental filing on the motion. Thereafter, the nonmovant shall file a response which shall include at least a brief memorandum of law as part of the response. Upon filing of the response, the movant's counsel shall contact the judicial assistant and advise that a non-hearing motion and response have been filed and provide copies of the filed motion and response. The Court shall consider the motion and response and issue a ruling.

Civil – Hearing Time Motion Calendar Docket

1. For short motion hearings (15 minutes or less), motion calendar dockets will be set on approximately every Monday at 9:00 am (CST) and 1:00 pm (CST), with each docket being one (1) hour long. Motion calendar dockets will be on Tuesday if Monday is a legal holiday, and such dockets will not be held on weeks when jury trials are scheduled.

2. It is anticipated that counsel can set hearings on a motion calendar docket with one to two weeks advanced notice.

3. Follow the procedures contained in the General Procedures on Page 2 (to include emailing the judicial assistant for available motion calendar dockets, clearing the hearing time with opposing counsel, confirming the date and providing a copy of the notice of hearing). Slots on each motion calendar docket <u>are limited</u>. Slots on a particular motion calendar docket will be given on a first come, <u>first confirmed basis</u>.

4. All matters set on a motion calendar should be noticed to start at 9:00 am (CST) or 1:00 pm (CST), depending on which docket is selected.

5. The case/motion will be called in the order that the motions are set for hearing.

6. The motion calendar is intended to hear short, simple motions on an expedited basis to keep a case moving (15-minute or less hearings). If extensive argument occurs, the hearing will be continued to a later time, to be set for a time certain under the General Procedures on Page 2. Accordingly, DO NOT try to set a matter on the motion calendar that cannot be concluded within 15 minutes as it will delay the conclusion of the hearing on the motion and annoy the other attorneys set for hearing on the motion calendar. If there is an abuse of the motion calendar docket by a particular attorney or law firm, it may result in the attorney/law firm not being able to set matters on the motion calendar in the future.

7. All hearings on the motion calendar will be held via Zoom Video – See page 9. Judge Henry will control admission of counsel from the Zoom waiting room. Therefore, remain on Zoom until admitted for the hearing on your case/motion, and do not disconnect if not admitted right at the start time of the docket.

Civil – Good Faith Certification for Motions

1. For most motions (other than truly dispositive motions), the moving party is required to include a certification in the motion that movant made a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) raised in the motion with the opposing counsel or party (whether represented or pro se) prior to filing the motion. This Court's requirement of conferral is broader than that included in Rule 1.202, Florida Rules of Civil Procedure.

2. A "good faith attempt" is not satisfied by the movant sending one or two emails to the opposing counsel or party if pro se and claiming no response was received. Movant may initiate the "good faith attempt" via email. However, if no response is received, the movant shall call the opposing counsel's office or party at least twice if no response is received to an email or initial phone call before certifying that the movant has made a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) raised in the motion.

3. The judicial assistant may reject offering hearing time if a motion does not include certification of a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) in the motion prior to filing the motion.

4. The only circumstances where a "good faith attempt" certification is not required is for dispositive motions (motions to dismiss with prejudice, motions for judgment on the pleadings, motions for summary judgment, etc.), emergency motions where the movant is not able to attempt contact because of the circumstances (however, delaying filing a motion that could be filed earlier is not considered an emergency just because the deadline is approaching), and post-trial or post-judgment motions (such as motions for rehearing or reconsideration). For motions to dismiss that raise primarily technical issues which, under applicable law would likely result in the pleading party being given leave to amend, the movant shall make a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) before filing the motion (e.g., where a party omits a copy of a contract or document from the complaint in an action for breach of contract).

Civil – Setting Trials

1. DO NOT request a case management conference (CMC) to set a case for trial, **unless:**

    a. setting a jury trial that will take longer than two weeks, or
    b. the parties cannot agree on a trial date.

    Multi-day non-jury trials may be set using the below procedures without the need for a CMC, unless the parties cannot agree on the dates for trial or the amount of time needed, in which case they must set a CMC to have the matter set for trial.

2. Be aware, unless specially set, jury trial dockets are one-week or two-week dockets.

3. If necessary, email a request to set a CMC to Judge Henry's assistant, Brittany Smith, and CC opposing counsel. These requests should be sent to smithb@jud14.flcourts.org.

4. Use Bay County case number and style of case as your subject line.

5. Provide the following information in the trial request email:

    a. Attach a copy of the filed notice for trial, if done
    b. Specify whether it is a jury trial or non-jury trial
    c. If a jury trial – specify the number of days needed, exclusive of jury selection
    d. If a non-jury trial – specify the amount of time needed. If over one day, a case management conference is needed

6. The judicial assistant will "reply all" to the email with available dates and instructions. READ ENTIRE EMAIL.

7. Only email the judicial assistant to set a CMC or confirm the trial date selected. DO NOT include the judicial assistant in email chains between counsel and/or staff to clear dates (or anything else).

8. For litigants' reference, existing jury trial dockets are listed on the next page. The litigants can avoid steps #3-6 above if they agree on a trial docket to set the matter. In that case, the procedure under #5 will include specifying the jury trial docket agreed to and specifying the number of days needed, exclusive of jury selection. The judicial assistant will then confirm receipt of the email agreeing to a docket.

9. Once the trial date is confirmed, Judge Henry will enter an order setting trial and pretrial dates, including discovery, disclosure and mediation deadlines. If the parties need to adjust any of the deadlines contained in the order setting trial, such can be submitted by stipulated order and will be permitted if they do not appear to affect preparation for trial.

Civil – Jury Trial Dockets

The future jury trial dockets set as of the date of this update to the administrative procedures are the following:

August 3-7, 2026	5-day docket
September 8-18, 2026	9-day docket
November 2-6, 2026	5-day docket
December 7-11, 2026	5-day docket
January 4-15, 2027	10-day docket
March 1-12, 2027	10-day docket
May 3-14, 2027	10-day docket
August 2-6, 2027	5-day docket
September 7-17, 2027	9-day docket
November 1-12, 2027	9-day docket

Civil – Zoom Instructions

1. These Zoom Instructions apply to Motion Calendar Dockets and any other hearing for which the Court permits appearance via Zoom.

2. Please be sure you have an adequate internet connection prior to logging into Zoom.

3. Counsel, parties, witnesses, court reporter and the judge will all appear via video.

4. Video Zoom connection information is as follows:

   https://zoom.us/j/6942431871
   Meeting ID: 694 243 1871

   Dial (for United States)
   +1 786 635 1003
   +1 301 715 8592

5. Include Zoom instructions above in any notices for hearing.

6. All counsel and parties attending a hearing shall do so using video, unless video is impossible.

7. As a video Zoom conference hearing is a court proceeding, counsel and any party attending a hearing will be properly attired and behave as if appearing in person in court.

8. So that hearings can promptly start, please log into the Zoom video conference at least five (5) minutes before the hearing start time. The judge will admit you to the hearing from the waiting room. DO NOT disconnect from Zoom just because you may not be admitted right at the hearing time.

9. So that Judge Henry can identify which persons in the waiting room are associated with a particular hearing, please set your Zoom user/screen name to your name or your firm's name (as opposed to a nickname or other phrase).

Civil – Submission of Proposed Orders

1. All proposed orders must be submitted via the e-filing portal.

2. All proposed orders must include a cover letter in .pdf format. The cover letter should indicate whether the proposed order is agreed to by opposing counsel/party or not.

3. **Only the cover letter and proposed order** should be submitted via the e-filing portal. Copies of motions, responses, exhibits, case law or other items should not be included with the cover letter or uploaded in the e-filing portal (see Submission of Hearing Materials, *infra*). The only exception to exclusion of other items pertains to the Pretrial Stipulated Order, in which case counsel shall either attach to the order or upload as a judicial exhibit the witness and exhibit lists to attach to the pretrial stip.

4. All proposed orders must be submitted in Word format. **Counsel and parties preparing orders are directed to remove any hidden formatting or codes**. Failure to remove hidden formatting may result in the order being rejected.

5. All proposed orders must be in DJCMA format (see #6 & 7 below), **but counsel/parties are directed to omit the service portion for the judicial assistant to sign and certify service of the order (the M and A portions of the DJCMA format)**.

6. Proposed orders do not need to include the addresses or email addresses of recipients of the order at the end. A copy of the signed order will be served on all counsel/parties registered for service via the e-portal.

7. If the case involves a pro se party who is not registered to receive filings from the e-portal, the proposed order shall include as the last paragraph (before DONE AND ORDERED) the following statement:

   > Counsel who submitted this proposed order to the Court for approval shall serve a copy of this Order on any party not registered to receive service via the Court's e-portal.

   Counsel receiving the served copy of an order entered is then charged with responsibility for serving (via mail or email) a copy of the signed order on any party not registered to receive service via the e-portal. The judge's office will not mail out copies of any orders.

8. A memo with instructions on submission of proposed orders and the DJCMA format can be accessed at: Microsoft Word - Memo-Submission of Proposed Orders to Judiciary.doc

9. A video with instructions on submission of proposed orders and the DJCMA format can be accessed on the 14th Judicial Circuit website under Announcements & Notices at: E-Filing Proposed Orders | Fourteenth Judicial Circuit

10. Any proposed order not complying with the above instructions will not be entered.

Civil – Submission of Hearing Materials
(Pleadings, Memoranda, Exhibits, Case Law)

1. Any documentation being used or relied upon at a hearing that a party wants the Court to review and consider must be submitted at least two (2) business days prior to the date of the hearing. This includes:

    a. Exhibits
    b. Memoranda not previously filed with the clerk
    c. Copies of case law, statutes or other citations
    d. Any demonstrative aides
    e. Any other documentation that a party intends to use at the hearing

    However, **additional copies of motions, memoranda already filed with the clerk or other documents which are already in the court file** (unless attached to or incorporated in other filings and not easily accessible or identifiable) **DO NOT need to be submitted again** prior to the hearing.

2. In lieu of hard copies of hearing materials, all hearing materials should be submitted via Microsoft OneDrive drop box. **DO NOT MAIL HARD COPIES OR A BINDER OF CASE LAW OR OTHER HEARING MATERIALS** unless specifically directed by the judicial assistant. The procedures for obtaining the drop box are:

    a. Any counsel or party that desires to provide hearing materials shall contact the judicial assistant and request a OneDrive drop box for the case at least two (2) business days prior to the hearing. Please be sure to include the email addresses of all parties/counsel who require access. The judicial assistant will send out an email to all parties with a link to the drop box.
    b. Either the movant or party opposing the motion may submit documents to the drop box
    c. Please label the documents submitted to the drop box so that they can be easily identified
    d. Any case law or other items being submitted should be uploaded as separate .pdf documents
    e. DO NOT upload documents as a zip file/folder as the Court will be unable to access those
    f. If documents being submitted include exhibits for an evidentiary hearing, please premark the exhibits and identify the party intending to introduce the exhibit. Counsel should agree on the method being used to identify the exhibits (such as one side using numbers and the opposing side using letters, or using party ID before the number/letter).
    g. **Counsel or any party will be responsible for redacting ALL confidential information on any document that will be offered into evidence**.
    h. All uploaded documents must be completed one (1) business day prior to the hearing.

3. Use of the OneDrive drop box is the preferred method to submit materials to the Court in advance of a hearing. If it is impossible to use the drop box, materials may be submitted in hard copy format, to be mailed so that the documents are received at least two (2) business days prior to the hearing.

4. For in person hearings, the uploading of exhibits to the OneDrive folder may be used for purposes of exchanging the exhibits with the opposing party. However, physical copies of the exhibits will be required for purposes of admission into evidence at the trial or hearing.

5. DO NOT email copies of hearing documents to the judicial assistant

Civil – Cancellations

1. In the event of a cancellation of a hearing, please notify the judicial assistant as promptly as possible to open the time for other cases.

2. In the event of a settlement or dismissal of a case set for trial, please notify the judicial assistant that the matter has settled or been dismissed so it can be removed from the trial docket, even if there are still matters remaining to be concluded (filing dismissal, signing of agreed upon settlement agreement, exchange of payment, etc.). However, if a settlement is contingent upon the agreement to the form of an agreement and/or release, please wait until the language of the agreement and/or release is agreed to by all parties prior to requesting a matter be removed from the trial docket.

3. Notices to the judicial assistant of a cancellation, settlement or dismissal should be sent via email.

4. Upon receipt by the judicial assistant of the email canceling a hearing or notifying of a settlement or dismissal, the matter will be removed from the calendar. It is suggested that counsel file and serve a notice of cancellation of a hearing, and upon filing, send a copy via email to the judicial assistant.

5. **Counsel and parties cannot cancel a trial or hearing scheduled by Court Order by simply filing a notice of cancellation without getting approval of the Court**.

Civil - Certification Regarding Standing Order And Administrative Procedures

1. Pursuant to the Standing Civil Case Management Order entered in most cases, counsel for all parties are required to file a certification that they have read and agree to abide by the Standing Order and these Administrative Procedures.

2. The Certification shall be substantially in the following form:

   I, on behalf of myself, my client and my law firm, have read the Standing Civil Case Management Order entered in this case as well as the presiding judge's Administrative Procedures found on the 14th Judicial Circuit's website and agree to abide by such requirements, procedures and deadlines. I understand that failure to comply with any of the requirements, procedures or deadlines may result in sanctions against me and/or my client, including, but not limited to, an award of attorney's fees and costs, denial of motions or hearing time, striking of pleadings, dismissal of claims, finding of contempt or other sanctions.

3. The Certification shall be filed by counsel or pro se parties pursuant to the time periods contained in the Standing Order entered in a case.

Family Law – Hearing Time
General Procedures

1. Verify Judge Henry is the judge assigned to the case

2. **PLEASE NOTE, for any matter that has not been set for hearing as of the effective date of this update, all specially set hearings (not including the Court's Motion Calendar Docket) will be held IN PERSON (not via Zoom) at the Bay County Courthouse, unless the Court specifically grants a request to appear via Zoom. Just because an attorney's office may be located outside of Bay County is not grounds to request to appear via Zoom. Frivolously requesting to appear via Zoom without demonstrating good cause or need may result in the imposition of sanctions.**

3. **Other than matters set on the Court's Motion Calendar Docket (see pg. 18), all specially set hearings will be for at least a thirty-five (35) minute hearing time**

4. DO NOT call the judge's office to request hearing time

5. Email request for hearing time to Judge Henry's assistant, Brittany Smith, and CC opposing counsel. These requests can be sent to smithb@jud14.flcourts.org.

6. Use Bay County case number and style of case as your subject line

7. Provide the following information in the hearing time request email:
    a. Type of petition(s)/motion(s) to be heard
    b. Actual amount of time needed for counsel to argue petition(s)/motion(s) – other than matters specified under #8 below
    c. First date movant is available for hearing
    d. Names of attorneys/parties that will attend hearing
    e. You may attach a copy of the petition(s)/motion(s) to the email

8. For the following petitions or motions, hearings will generally be scheduled for a maximum of these amounts of time (without prior permission of the Court and based on unusual circumstances):

    a. Petition/motion for temporary relief — 1 hour
    b. Petition/motion for child pick up — 1 hour
    c. Exception hearings — 1 hour
    d. Pretrials, case management, non-evidentiary motions — 15 min per motion

    Final hearings can be set for half day or all day. Half day hearings are set from 9:00 to 12:00 or 1:30 to 4:30. All day hearings are set from 9:00 to 4:30.

9. Final hearings will be noticed by entry of an Order prepared and entered by the Court. For all other hearings not set by the Court, a Notice of Hearing should be prepared and filed by counsel or a pro se party.

10. Judicial assistant will "reply all" to the email with available dates, times and instructions. READ ENTIRE EMAIL. Be aware that Bay County is in the central time zone.

11. Only email the judicial assistant to request dates and confirm the hearing date. DO NOT include the judicial assistant in email chains between counsel and/or staff to clear dates (or anything else).

12. DO NOT file a notice of hearing before receiving a confirmation email from the judicial assistant confirming that the hearing has been set

13. Email the judicial assistant a copy of all notices for hearing once filed

14. Any motions noticed, but not specifically scheduled with the judicial assistant, will not be heard

15. Additional motions cannot be piggybacked on a previously scheduled hearing time without being cleared with the judicial assistant and opposing counsel, and provided sufficient time has been reserved. To add a motion to a previously scheduled hearing, obtain opposing counsel's consent to the addition, then email the judicial assistant about adding the motion to the hearing. The judicial assistant will confirm the addition of the motion to the hearing time. Do not prepare and file a notice of the added motion until receipt of the judicial assistant's confirmation.

16. Address: 300 E. 4th Street, Panama City, FL 32401. There is no room number – just list as Judge Henry's Chambers.

Family – Hearing Time Motion Calendar Docket

1. For short motion hearings (15 minutes or less), motion calendar dockets will be set on approximately every Monday at 9:00 am (CST) and 1:00 pm (CST), with each docket being one (1) hour long. Motion calendar dockets will be on Tuesday if Monday is a legal holiday, and such dockets will not be held on weeks when jury trials are scheduled.

2. It is anticipated that counsel can set hearings on a motion calendar docket with one to two weeks advanced notice.

3. Follow the procedures contained in the General Procedures on Page 16 (to include emailing the judicial assistant for available motion calendar dockets, clearing the hearing time with opposing counsel, confirming the date and providing a copy of the notice of hearing). Slots on each motion calendar docket are limited. Slots on a particular motion calendar docket will be given on a first come, first confirmed basis.

4. All matters set on a motion calendar should be noticed to start at 9:00 am (CST) or 1:00 pm (CST), depending on which docket is selected.

5. The case/motion will be called in the order that the motions are set for hearing.

6. The motion calendar is intended to hear short, simple motions on an expedited basis to keep a case moving (15-minute or less hearings). If extensive argument occurs, the hearing will be continued to a later time, to be set for a time certain under the General Procedures on Page 16. Accordingly, DO NOT try to set a matter on the motion calendar that cannot be concluded within 15 minutes as it will delay the conclusion of the hearing on the motion and annoy the other attorneys set for hearing on the motion calendar. If there is an abuse of the motion calendar docket by a particular attorney or law firm, it may result in the attorney/law firm not being able to set matters on the motion calendar in the future.

7. All hearings on the motion calendar will be held via Zoom Video – See page 21. Judge Henry will control admission of counsel from the Zoom waiting room. Therefore, remain on Zoom until admitted for the hearing on your case/motion, and do not disconnect if not admitted right at the start time of the docket.

Family – Good Faith Certification for Motions

1. For most motions (other than truly dispositive motions), the moving party is required to include a certification in the motion that movant made a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) raised in the motion with the opposing counsel or party (whether represented or pro se) prior to filing the motion. Although there is not a corollary rule under the Florida Family Law Rules of Procedure, this Court requires a good faith conferral on non-dispositive matters, and this requirement is broader than that included in Rule 1.202, Florida Rules of Civil Procedure

2. A "good faith attempt" is not satisfied by the movant sending one or two emails to the opposing counsel or party if pro se and claiming no response was received. Movant may initiate the "good faith attempt" via email. However, if no response is received, the movant shall call the opposing counsel's office or party at least twice if no response is received to an email or initial phone call before certifying that the movant has made a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) raised in the motion.

3. The judicial assistant may reject offering hearing time if a motion does not include certification of a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) in the motion prior to filing the motion.

4. The only circumstances where a "good faith attempt" certification is not required is for truly dispositive motions, emergency motions where the movant is not able to attempt contact because of the circumstances (however, delaying filing a motion that could be filed earlier is not considered an emergency just because the deadline is approaching), and post-trial or post-judgment motions (such as motions for rehearing or reconsideration). For motions to dismiss that raise primarily technical issues which, under applicable law would likely result in the pleading party being given leave to amend, the movant shall make a "good faith attempt" to resolve the issue(s) before filing the motion (e.g., where a party omits a required document from the petition).

Family Law – Final Hearing Dates

1. DO NOT request a case management conference to obtain final hearing dates, unless the parties cannot agree on the dates or the amount of time needed.

2. Email request for final hearing dates to Judge Henry's assistant, Brittany Smith, and CC opposing counsel. These requests can be sent to smithb@jud14.flcourts.org.

3. Use Bay County case number and style of case as your subject line. Include any and all pending pleadings that will be addressed at the final hearing (e.g, initial petition, answer and counter-petition, etc.), and the amount of time needed.

4. Judicial assistant will "reply all" to the email with available dates and instructions. READ ENTIRE EMAIL.

5. Only email the judicial assistant to request dates and confirm the final date selected. DO NOT include the judicial assistant in email chains between counsel and/or staff to clear dates (or anything else).

6. Once the final hearing date is confirmed, the Court will issue an order setting the final hearing with other deadlines.

Family Law – Zoom Instructions

1. These Zoom Instructions apply to any hearing scheduled or for which the Court permits appearance via Zoom.

2. Please be sure you have an adequate internet connection prior to logging into Zoom.

3. Counsel, parties, witnesses, court reporter and the judge will all appear via video.

4. Video Zoom connection information is as follows:

   https://zoom.us/j/6942431871
   Meeting ID: 694 243 1871

   Dial (for United States)
   +1 786 635 1003
   +1 301 715 8592

5. Include Zoom instructions above in any notices for hearing.

6. All counsel and parties attending a hearing shall do so using video, unless video is impossible.

7. As a video Zoom conference hearing is a court proceeding, counsel and any party attending a hearing will be properly attired and behave as if appearing in person in court.

8. So that hearings can promptly start, please log into the Zoom video conference at least five (5) minutes before the hearing start time. The judge will admit you to the hearing from the waiting room. DO NOT disconnect from Zoom just because you may not be admitted right at the hearing time.

9. So that Judge Henry can identify which persons in the waiting room are associated with a particular hearing, please set your Zoom user/screen name to your name or your firm's name (as opposed to a nickname or other phrase).

Family Law – Submission of Proposed Orders

1. All proposed orders must be submitted via the e-filing portal.

2. All proposed orders must include a cover letter in .pdf format. The cover letter should indicate whether the proposed order is agreed to by opposing counsel/party or not.

3. **Only the cover letter and proposed order** should be submitted via the e-filing portal. Copies of motions, responses, exhibits, case law or other items should not be included with the cover letter or uploaded in the e-filing portal (see Submission of Hearing Materials, *infra*). The only exception to exclusion of other items pertains to the attachments or appendices that need to be attached to the order, in which case counsel shall either attach such to the order or upload as a judicial exhibit the attachment or appendix to attach to the pretrial stip.

4. All proposed orders must be submitted in Word format. **Counsel and parties preparing orders are directed to remove any hidden formatting or codes**. Failure to remove hidden formatting may result in the order being rejected.

5. All proposed orders must be in DJCMA format (see #6 & 7 below), **but counsel/parties are directed to omit the service portion for the judicial assistant to sign and certify service of the order (the M and A portions of the DJCMA format)**.

6. Proposed orders do not need to include the addresses or email addresses of recipients of the order at the end. A copy of the signed order will be served on all counsel/parties registered for service via the e-portal.

7. If the case involves a pro se party who is not registered to receive filings from the e-portal, the proposed order shall include as the last paragraph (before DONE AND ORDERED) the following statement:

   > Counsel who submitted this proposed order to the Court for approval shall serve a copy of this Order on any party not registered to receive service via the Court's e-portal.

   Counsel receiving the served copy of an order entered is then charged with responsibility for serving (via mail or email) a copy of the signed order on any party not registered to receive service via the e-portal. The judge's office will not mail out copies of any orders.

8. A memo with instructions on submission of proposed orders and the DJCMA format can be accessed at: Microsoft Word - Memo-Submission of Proposed Orders to Judiciary.doc (flcourts.org)

9. A video with instructions on submission of proposed orders and the DJCMA format can be accessed on the 14th Judicial Circuit website under Announcements & Notices at: Fourteenth Judicial Circuit of Florida | (flcourts.org)

10. Any proposed order not complying with the above instructions will not be entered.

Family Law – Submission of Hearing Materials (Pleadings, Memoranda, Exhibits, Case Law)

1. Any documentation being used or relied upon at a hearing that a party wants the Court to review and consider must be submitted at least two (2) business days prior to the date of the hearing. This includes:

    a. Exhibits
    b. Memoranda not previously filed with the clerk
    c. Copies of case law, statutes or other citations
    d. Any demonstrative aides
    e. Any other documentation that a party intends to use at the hearing

    However, additional copies of motions, memoranda already filed with the clerk or other documents which are already in the court file (unless attached to or incorporated in other filings and not easily accessible or identifiable) do not need to be submitted again prior to the hearing.

2. In lieu of sending an email with attachments or hard copies of hearing materials, all hearing materials should be submitted via Microsoft OneDrive drop box. The procedures of obtaining the drop box are:

    a. Any counsel or party that desires to provide hearing materials shall contact the judicial assistant and request a OneDrive drop box for the case. The email request shall be copied to all other counsel or parties. The judicial assistant will send out an email to all parties with a link to the drop box.
    b. Either the movant or party opposing the motion may submit documents to the drop box
    c. Please label the documents submitted to the drop box so that they can be easily identified
    d. If documents being submitted include exhibits for an evidentiary hearing, please premark the exhibits and identify the party intending to introduce the exhibit. Counsel should agree on the method being used to identify the exhibits (such as one side using numbers and the opposing side using letters or using party ID before the number/letter).

3. Use of the OneDrive drop box is the preferred method to submit materials to the Court in advance of a hearing. If it is impossible to use the drop box, materials may be submitted in hard copy format, to be mailed so that the documents are received at least two (2) business days prior to the hearing.

4. For in person hearings, the uploading of exhibits to the OneDrive folder may be used for purposes of exchanging the exhibits with the opposing party. However, physical copies of the exhibits will be required for purposes of admission into evidence at the trial or hearing.

5. DO NOT email copies of hearing documents to the judicial assistant

Family Law – Cancellations

1. In the event of a cancellation of a hearing, please notify the judicial assistant as promptly as possible to open the time for other cases.

2. In the event of a settlement or dismissal of a case set for final hearing, please notify the judicial assistant that the matter has settled or been dismissed so it can be removed from the final hearing docket, even if there are still matters remaining to be concluded (filing of signed settlement agreement, entry of final judgment, etc.). However, if a settlement is contingent upon the agreement to the form of an agreement, please wait until the language of the agreement is agreed to by all parties prior to requesting a matter be removed from the final hearing docket.

3. Notices to the judicial assistant of a cancellation, settlement or dismissal should be sent via email.

4. Upon receipt by the judicial assistant of the email canceling a hearing or notifying of a settlement or dismissal, the matter will be removed from the calendar. It is suggested that a notice of cancellation be filed, and a copy the notice of cancellation should be sent via email to the judicial assistant. Filing such a notice and providing such to any opposing counsel or party (especially in the case of opposing pro se parties) is considered good professionalism and courtesy. **A hearing or final hearing set by Court order may not be cancelled without entry of a Court order**.